# Mingpu Xiao

Department of Political Science, University of California, San Diego

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## Education

**University of California, San Diego** Expected June 2027

Ph.D., Political Science with Specialization in Computational Social Science
Subfields: Comparative Politics, Political Methodology
Dissertation: *The Political Logic of State Capitalism*

**University of California, San Diego** 2020

Master of International Affairs
Career Track: International Economics

**Nanjing University** 2018

M.A. in Political Science
Certificate in Chinese and American Studies, Johns Hopkins–Nanjing Center 2017

**Beijing Institute of Technology** 2015

B.A. in Economics

## Research

**Research Interests**: Authoritarian Politics; Chinese Politics; Comparative and International Political Economy; State-Building and Democratization; Public Opinion and Contentious Politics

### Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Xiao, Mingpu, and Tangbiao Xiao. 2017. "Determinants of Public Attitudes toward Political Order" (in Chinese). *Administrative Tribune* 24(5). Chinese Social Sciences Citation Index (CSSCI).

### Book Chapters

- Xiao, Mingpu, and Tangbiao Xiao. "The Evolution, Typology, and Characteristics of Chinese Citizens' Economic Values" (in Chinese). In *Report on Social Governance in the New Era*, edited by Wenfang Tang, Jie Chen, and Tangbiao Xiao. Guangzhou: Sun Yat-sen University Press. (Forthcoming 2026)

### Working Papers

- "Legitimizing State Capitalism: External Threat, Nationalism, and Support for State Ownership" (Job Market Paper)
- "Economic Foundations of Authoritarian Leviathans: State-Owned Enterprises and State-Building in Contemporary China"
- "Sanctioned into Statism: Trade Embargoes and Public Demand for State Control"
- "Modernization in the Shadow of Leviathan: State-Directed Development and the Paths to Democracy"
- "Market Socialists and State Capitalists: The Structure of Economic Values in China and the World" (with Tangbiao Xiao)

- "The Ideational Dimension of China's Stability: Conceptualizing, Measuring, and Classifying Public Attitudes toward Political Order" (with Tangbiao Xiao; in Chinese). Under review.
- "International Origins of Populism: WTO and U.S. Presidential Elections" (with Marc-Andreas Muendler, T. Renee Bowen, and J. Lawrence Broz)

**Work in Progress**

- *State Capitalism in the Twenty-First Century* (book project)

## Conference Presentations

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| Chinese Politics Mini-Conference, APSA | 2026 |
| UCSD Young Scholars Conference | 2026 |
| MPSA | 2026 |

## Grants, Fellowships, and Awards

**UC San Diego**

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| Yankelovich Center Research Grant | 2026 |
| Dean's Research and Travel Grant | 2024–2025 |
| Richard Covington Best Paper Award | 2020 |
| Dean's Fellowship | 2019 |
| Robinson Summer Research Fellow | 2019 |

## Selected Teaching Experience

**Section Instructor**

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| Political Inquiry (Research Methods) | Fall 2025, Spring 2025 |
| Introduction to Comparative Politics | Winter 2025, Fall 2024, Fall 2023 |

**Teaching Assistant**

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| The Chinese Revolution | Spring 2024 |
| Applied Data Analysis in Political Science | Summer 2023 |
| The Politics of Food in a Global Economy | Spring 2023 |
| Politics of Development | Winter 2023 |
| Data Analytics for the Social Sciences | Spring 2022 |
| Political Development of Western Europe | Winter 2022 |
| Policy Responses to Global Problems (Master's Capstone) | Fall 2021 |

## Research Experience

**Research Assistant** 2022 – Present

21st Century China Center, UC San Diego

- *China from the Ground Up Survey*: designed, coordinated, and fielded online surveys of Chinese citizens' political attitudes; analyzed and visualized survey data and disseminated findings to academic and public audiences.
- Collected and analyzed data on local government debt in China.
- Maintained a large-scale corpus of Chinese newspapers.

**Research Associate** 2020 – 2021

Center for Commerce and Diplomacy, UC San Diego

- Applied causal inference and machine learning methods to analyze the impact of WTO Appellate Body rulings on U.S. presidential elections, resulting in the working paper "International Origins of Populism: WTO and U.S. Presidential Elections."

**Robinson Summer Research Fellow** Summer 2019

School of Global Policy and Strategy, UC San Diego

- Analyzed data from eight survey experiments testing the causal effects of international election observation and foreign meddling on trust in elections; findings were incorporated into the book *Monitors and Meddlers: How Foreign Actors Influence Local Trust in Elections* (by Sarah S. Bush and Lauren Prather).

**Research Assistant** 2015 – 2018

Center for Public Affairs and Local Governance, Nanjing University

- *Chinese Citizens' Political Values Survey* (2015–2018): contributed to questionnaire design and data collection; applied model-based statistical inference to measure and predict citizens' political values along dimensions such as democracy, order, the rule of law, and civil liberties (Jiangsu Province).
- *Asian Barometer Survey* (2015): conducted fieldwork in urban and rural Anhui Province as a survey team supervisor; organized GIS-based household sampling and completed questionnaire data collection.
- *Local Governance and Reform* (2016–2018): contributed to survey design and data collection and interviewed local government officials; combined quantitative analysis with case studies to examine the relationships among urbanization, local administrative reform, public attitudes, and political participation (Pukou District, Nanjing).
- *Grassroots Elections and Democracy in Rural China* (2012, 2015): conducted fieldwork in rural Jiangxi Province, observing village committee elections, interviewing village cadres and villagers, and collecting survey data; wrote research reports analyzing the relationships among lineage networks, social capital, electoral participation, and public goods provision.

## Skills

- **Programming and data:** R, Python, Stata, SQL (MySQL), LaTeX, ArcGIS
- **Languages:** Chinese (native); English (fluent)

## References

**Margaret E. Roberts** (Advisor)
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**Victor Shih** (Advisor)
Professor, School of Global Policy and Strategy
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